

9 The future

What's new in OpenSolaris 2010.03?

OpenSolaris 2010.03 will be released next month in March, which will be the next major release after OpenSolaris 2009.06. These are some of the new features which will be added to OpenSolaris 2010.03.

Facet support in IPS - Facet support in IPS allows users to filter out what they choose to install onto their system, for example, a particular language or locale choice, developer heads or documentation. Users and administrators can now choose to install particular parts of a software package onto their system, without the complexity of having to install a myriad of individual software packages supporting that choice. The addition of facet support allows ISVs to package their application as a single software package, and provide a set of pre-defined filters.

VM Constructor - The VM Constructors allows users to create virtual images based on selections of software, exported as an OVF appliance. Virtualization provides a popular and convenient way of deploying services within an enterprise environment. The VM constructor allows users to create specific virtualized images to be used in any hypervisor that supports the OVF 1.0 specification.

Extended partition support and partition editor: OpenSolaris now supports the ability to install and boot from a logical drive within an extended partition. The gparted tool on the OpenSolaris LiveCD allows the ability to resize/reconfigure existing partitions to more easily install OpenSolaris. OpenSolaris can now be installed into an extended partition, allowing users the additional flexibility with other operating systems in a multi-boot environment. The user can now easily modify existings partitions from the LiveCD environment with a simple to use partition editor.

ZFS deduplication and ZFS user/group quotas: ZFS deduplication is the process of eliminating duplicate copies of data. Data quotas can now be set for users and groups. ZFS deduplication can be used to preserve space on disk when multiple snapshot or file system clones have been made (including boot environments). ZFS user and group quotas provide missing functionality allowing administrators easy control over disk usage when managing servers with thousands of users.

Addition of Visual Panels in OpenSolaris default installation: Although